CSIS JAPAN CHAIR

Japan Daily Brief

Tuesday, October 13, 2026

1,865 words · 7 min read

RE: DPRK tactical missile salvo · BOJ leans against Oct hike · Agriculture Minister scandal deepens · Anthropic/NTT data center · US-Japan FOIP Dialogue

NIKKEI 225	USD/JPY	BRENT	BOJ RATE
67,777.52	158.10	$104.59	1.25%
▼ -4.11%	▼ -0.13%	▲ +0.30%	

TOP STORIES

DPRK

North Korea fires multiple ballistic missiles into Sea of Japan, claims tactical upgrade 'big success'

North Korea launched multiple ballistic missiles toward the Sea of Japan on Monday morning; KCNA subsequently claimed the salvo tested an upgraded 'tactical' ballistic missile and declared it a 'big success.' One missile traveled *over 910 km*, according to South Korean tracking data reported by Militarnyi, days after South Korea's own first domestic hypersonic weapon test.

REUTERS

DPRK

South Korea, US, Japan hold trilateral consultations after North Korea missile launches

South Korea, the United States, and Japan convened consultations following Monday's North Korean ballistic missile launches, jointly urging Pyongyang to halt provocation. The US, Japan, and South Korea also separately reaffirmed commitment to complete denuclearization of North Korea in high-level talks reported by Yonhap.

YONHAP

ALLIANCE

Takaichi pledges support for the ICC and its Japanese president

Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** stated Japan will continue to communicate with the United States following Washington's imposition of sanctions on the International Criminal Court, reaffirming support for the court and its Japanese president. The stance keeps Takaichi caught between alliance loyalty to Washington and Japan's commitment to multilateral legal institutions.

THE JAPAN TIMES

POLITICS-DIET

Japan farm minister remains on defensive amid series of allegations

Agriculture Minister **Kazuo Yana** continued to face parliamentary questioning Tuesday over a string of allegations including election violation claims, budget-cut remarks, and prior conduct issues; the main opposition party formally demanded his resignation. Prime Minister Takaichi said she would not hesitate to dismiss Yana if illegal conduct is confirmed, acknowledging the question of her appointment responsibility.

MAINICHI

ALLIANCE

US and Japan hold Second Free and Open Indo-Pacific Dialogue

The US Department of State convened the Second US-Japan Free and Open Indo-Pacific (FOIP) Dialogue, affirming continued bilateral coordination on the shared FOIP vision. The dialogue advances the institutional architecture for US-Japan strategic alignment across the Indo-Pacific.

US DEPARTMENT OF STATE · OCT 13

ECONOMY-BOJ

BOJ said to lean against back-to-back rate hike in October

Bank of Japan officials are said to lean against raising rates at the October meeting following the September BOJ hike, according to Bloomberg, with producer price data showing deceleration to *6.8%* year-on-year reinforcing the wait-and-see posture. Governor Ueda separately stated long-term rates are market-determined, avoiding forward guidance.

BLOOMBERG

STAT OF THE DAY

6.8%

Japan September producer price index, year-on-year

The BOJ's Corporate Goods Price Index slowed from 7.6% in August to 6.8% in September, easing near-term urgency for an October rate hike.

Producer price growth cools, easing urgency for further Bank of Japan hikes — Japan Times

JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

KANTEI/PM · CABINET · MOFA · MOD · METI · MOF · BOJ · DIET · TUESDAY, OCTOBER 13, 2026

PM Watch: PM appeared today · 0 day(s) since last confirmed appearance — PM Takaichi publicly raised the possibility of dismissing Agriculture Minister Yana if illegality is confirmed, reaffirmed Japan's support for the ICC and its Japanese president in response to US sanctions, and pledged to finalize the foreign resident basic policy by March 2027.

防衛省・統合幕僚監部 · MINISTRY OF DEFENSE / JOINT STAFF

MOD issues multiple urgent bulletins on North Korea ballistic missile launches

Japan's Ministry of Defense issued a series of flash and estimated-impact reports (12a through 12e) on October 12 following North Korea's multiple ballistic missile launches toward the Sea of Japan. Joint Staff tracked trajectories and confirmed splashdown estimates outside Japan's territory.

防衛省 · MINISTRY OF DEFENSE

MOD updates France's maritime monitoring of North Korean ship-to-ship transfers

Japan's Ministry of Defense updated its page on French surveillance operations against North Korean vessels engaged in illicit ship-to-ship transfers ('ship seizure' / 瀬取り), reflecting ongoing multilateral maritime enforcement activity.

日本銀行 · BANK OF JAPAN · *Kazuo Ueda, Governor*

Governor Ueda states long-term interest rates are market-determined

BOJ Governor **Kazuo Ueda** reiterated that long-term interest rates are determined in markets reflecting various factors, a statement interpreted by analysts as non-committal on the pace of further hikes ahead of the October policy meeting.

→ fxstreet.com ↗

官邸 · PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE (KANTEI) · *Sanae Takaichi, Prime Minister*

PM Takaichi raises possibility of dismissing Agriculture Minister Yana if illegality confirmed

Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** publicly stated she would not hesitate to dismiss Agriculture Minister **Kazuo Yana** if illegal conduct is established, amid a series of scandal allegations including an election violation accusation reported Tuesday. Asahi Shimbun reported her remarks under the framing that her appointment responsibility is now in question.

→ Asahi ↗

内閣・政府 · CABINET / GOVERNMENT LEGISLATIVE BUREAU

Cabinet presents bill to ruling coalition requiring permits for land acquisition near security-critical facilities

The government presented to the ruling coalition a draft bill that would require prior approval for acquisition of land parcels near facilities deemed important to national security. The proposal advances Japan's economic security legislation addressing foreign ownership risks near defense installations.

→ Asahi ↗

内閣 · CABINET / GOVERNMENT

Cabinet backs plan to subsidize higher oil transport costs for importers via three bills on 'de-Hormuz' routing

Japan's cabinet approved a package of three bills providing subsidies to oil importers using alternative, non-Strait of Hormuz routing, a contingency-supply strategy aimed at reducing exposure to Middle East chokepoint risk. The bills reflect a broader government effort to diversify crude procurement amid elevated energy prices.

→ Reuters ↗

DIET SESSIONS / LDP

OPPOSITION / CDP

Main opposition party calls for Yana's resignation over accumulating scandals

Japan's main opposition party formally urged Agriculture Minister Yana to resign, citing the accumulation of scandal allegations as incompatible with continued service. The demand intensifies pressure on Prime Minister Takaichi, who personally favored his appointment.

LDP / KANTEI

Diet attendance record of PM Takaichi draws scrutiny and stokes debate

A report questioning Prime Minister Takaichi's Diet attendance record sparked public debate, raising accountability questions for a prime minister simultaneously managing a heavy diplomatic schedule and domestic scandal fallout.

PUBLIC SENTIMENT & APPROVAL POLLING

POLLSTER	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE
JNN · Oct 4, 2026	**63%**	**33.9%**
Asahi · Sep 28, 2026	**51%**	**33%**
ANN · Sep 23, 2026	**58.3%**	**27.6%**
Kyodo · Sep 23, 2026	**53.4%**	**30.9%**
Nikkei · Sep 5, 2026 · **38d ago**	**62%**	**33%**
Yomiuri · Sep 19, 2026 · **24d ago**	**59%**	**30%**
FNN · Sep 15, 2026 · **28d ago**	**61.6%**	**32.2%**
NHK · Sep 10, 2026 · **33d ago**	**52.8%**	**30.8%**

Discourse: Agriculture Minister Yana's accumulating scandals — now including an election violation accusation — are intensifying parliamentary pressure on PM Takaichi and raising her appointment-responsibility exposure just as the extraordinary Diet session is under way.

Poll tracker: **Observing Japan approval-rating aggregator →**

BUSINESS & ECONOMY

TECH · NIKKEI ASIA · NTT DATA, ANTHROPIC

NTT Data in final talks to build Anthropic's first data center in Japan

NTT Data is in final negotiations to construct Anthropic's first data center in Japan, with a site in Osaka under discussion per Nikkei and Reuters reports. The facility would be Anthropic's inaugural physical AI infrastructure presence in Asia.

TECH · NIKKEI ASIA · OMRON, ONLOGIC

Omron to acquire US industrial PC maker OnLogic for $675 million in physical AI push

Japan's **Omron** agreed to acquire US-based OnLogic for *$675 million*, targeting the industrial computing and 'physical AI' market where software-driven automation meets factory hardware. The deal represents one of Japan's larger outbound technology acquisitions in the current cycle.

MACRO · THE JAPAN TIMES

IMF raises Japan's 2026 growth forecast to 0.7%

The International Monetary Fund raised its Japan growth forecast for 2026 to *0.7%*, citing stabilization as the energy shock dissipates and monetary policy gradually normalizes. The upward revision coincides with the BOJ's own September Consumer Opinion Survey release.

REGIONAL PRESSURE WATCH WATCH

High — 73 items (DPRK: 69, BOJ: 3, China MOFA: 1)

CHINA

China's Global Times published a piece urging Japan's leaders to 'heed voices of justice at home,' continuing Beijing's coordinated messaging campaign against Tokyo. No new China Coast Guard territorial-water intrusion or PLA activity near the Senkakus was reported in today's Tier 4 data; the prior tracker records a four-vessel CCG intrusion on October 10.

NORTH KOREA

North Korea fired *multiple ballistic missiles* into the Sea of Japan early Monday; KCNA claimed the salvo tested an upgraded 'tactical' ballistic missile and declared it a 'big success,' with one missile reportedly traveling over 910 km. South Korea, the US, and Japan held immediate trilateral consultations and jointly called on Pyongyang to halt provocation; President Trump separately indicated he 'may' meet Kim Jong Un.

RUSSIA

No new Russian military activity near Hokkaido or the Northern Territories was reported in today's Tier 4 data; the prior tracker records Japan's ongoing protest of Russia's extradition request targeting ICC President Akane.

Senkaku / ECS: No new China Coast Guard intrusion into Senkaku territorial waters is confirmed in today's Tier 4 data; the most recent confirmed intrusion in the tracker was October 10 (four CCG vessels).

> *“China urges Japan's leaders to heed voices of justice at home”*
>
> Chinese Foreign Ministry (spokesperson, unnamed) · China urges Japan's leaders to heed voices of justice at home: FM — Global Times

Bottom line: North Korea's tactical ballistic missile salvo — its most recent in a sustained test streak — triggered immediate US-Japan-ROK trilateral consultations; Trump's signal of a possible Kim meeting adds diplomatic complexity to allied deterrence coordination. The BOJ's October rate decision is the parallel domestic watch, with producer price deceleration and Bloomberg reporting a lean against a consecutive hike.

U.S.-JAPAN RELATIONS

BASING · MAINICHI

Japan-US talks begin on off-base conduct policy after Okinawa Marine murder

Japan and the United States have commenced bilateral talks on measures to prevent crimes by US military personnel following the alleged murder of an Okinawan woman by a US Marine, with Mainichi confirming negotiations are underway. Prime Minister Takaichi previously stated publicly that talks on preventing recurrence have begun.

ALLIANCE · US DEPARTMENT OF STATE

Second US-Japan FOIP Dialogue held, advancing bilateral Indo-Pacific coordination

The US Department of State held the Second US-Japan Free and Open Indo-Pacific Dialogue, marking an institutionalized bilateral mechanism for FOIP implementation. The dialogue advances joint architecture on the shared strategic vision underpinning the alliance.

INDO-PACIFIC PARTNERS

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA

Former PM Kishida: Japan should help ASEAN reintegrate Myanmar

Former Prime Minister **Fumio Kishida** stated in a Nikkei Asia interview that Japan should assist ASEAN efforts to bring Myanmar back into the regional fold, indicating continued Japanese diplomatic engagement on the Myanmar issue through former leadership.

SOUTHEAST ASIA · CHINA-GLOBAL SOUTH PROJECT

Japan courts Vietnam as it expands security partnerships to counter China

Japan is actively cultivating closer security ties with Vietnam as part of a broader strategy to expand partnerships across Southeast Asia that counterbalance China's regional influence.

KOREA-JAPAN · 헤럴드경제

Yonhap News to hold forum on economic cooperation between South Korea and Japan

Yonhap News Agency is organizing a forum on economic cooperation between South Korea and Japan, providing a structured track-two venue for bilateral economic dialogue.

UPCOMING

Oct 14

BOJ October Monetary Policy Meeting window approaches

Bloomberg reported the BOJ is leaning against a back-to-back rate hike in October; the next policy decision will be watched closely given September producer price cooling and the BOJ's stated data-dependence. Exact meeting date not specified in today's articles — verify.

Oct 16

Japan-US off-duty conduct talks ongoing — outcome watch

Japan and the United States have begun talks on preventing crimes by US military personnel following the Okinawa murder case; a Mainichi report confirms negotiations are underway without specifying a resolution date.

Nov 1

APEC summit — Xi-Takaichi bilateral still unconfirmed

Beijing has not confirmed whether President Xi Jinping will hold a bilateral with PM Takaichi at APEC; China has maintained preconditions related to Takaichi's Taiwan-related statements. Date is estimated based on tracker history — verify.

Mar 31

PM Takaichi's foreign resident basic policy deadline

Prime Minister Takaichi has pledged to finalize Japan's basic policy on foreign residents by March 2027, with population projections and foreign worker quota adjustments under review.

Mar 31

Current Host-Nation Support Special Measures Agreement expiration

The current US-Japan Special Measures Agreement (approximately ¥211 billion/year) runs through March 31, 2027; no renegotiation update in today's articles.

CSIS Japan Chair

JAPAN DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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